

Autorità signorile e fonti del diritto. Le «*Constitutiones appellationum*» di Antonio, Guidantonio e Federico da Montefeltro (Urbino, 1384-1559), Course: Storia del diritto medievale e moderno (prof. Sandro Notari). Università di Urbino, Dipartimento di Giurisprudenza - 16 April 2026, Urbino, Italy.

Translated Title : *The Lord and the Law: The Constitutiones appellationum of Antonio, Guidantonio, and Federico of Montefeltro (Urbino, 1384–1559)*

We tend to think of law as something the state makes — its most visible, and perhaps most important, product. But has this always been the case? And can the opposite hold true? The Italian Renaissance states, and the signoria of Urbino in particular, are especially instructive on this point. Drawing on Urbino's statutory legislation — above all the unpublished series of the *Constitutiones appellationum*, issued by Antonio, Guidantonio, and Federico da Montefeltro (1384–1559) — this lecture examines the relationship between state and law as a constitutive feature of European legal history. Against the view that late-medieval signorie asserted themselves without, and before, any project for territorial governance — relying on piecemeal, occasional legislation — the *Constitutiones* represent instead an example of "government through law." They are, moreover, a precious source in an otherwise patchy landscape of surviving statutory material, and one that opens the way to long-term comparison of how legislative systems evolved within Urbino.

PROIEZIONE TERRITORIALE DELLO STATO DI URBINO (XIII-XVI secc.)

